

Reclaiming land outside the Freeport

A Budget promise, tested against satellite images, seabed and protected-area maps and research

THE CLAIM

“The Government is preparing to launch a large-scale land reclamation project outside the Freeport...”

Clyde Caruana, Minister for Finance, Budget Speech 2026, 27 October 2025

“...perimeter next year.” In 2019: a seabed study found “environmentally safe” sites.

Checked one year on, 3 October 2026.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Existing works real;
new project not shown.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+3.7 ha

Reclamation under way

Satellite images confirm new land at Freeport Terminal 2 since 2023.

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Published details

No site, size, cost, fill source or assessment for the large project.

7 yrs

Seabed study unpublished

Promised for public consultation in 2019; still not public.

72 ha

Mapped seagrass nearby

Posidonia mapped within 1 km of the new land (coarse 2016 map); a marine bird area 0.4 km away.

Stable

Malta's seagrass overall

Malta reports its Posidonia beds favourable and stable; the 34% loss is Mediterranean-wide.

FAIR TO SAY

Moving industry away from homes could help residents, and Malta's seagrass is in good condition overall. The plan may prove sound once the study and a site are published.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The ERA seabed study.

☐ Site, size and fill source.

☐ Any environmental screening.

☐ Which activities would move.